

RIFAT ERDEM SAHIN

DEVOPS AI ENGINEER — CI/CD, GITOPS & INTELLIGENT DELIVERY AUTOMATION

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<https://calendly.com/rifaterdem/schedule>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps AI Engineer with **12+ years of experience** building CI/CD platforms, GitOps delivery pipelines, and Infrastructure-as-Code across regulated finance, energy, and Critical National Infrastructure (CNI) environments. Deep hands-on background spanning **build/test pipelines, automated multi-environment deployments, canary/blue-green rollout strategies, Terraform/Helm-based IaC, and secrets/RBAC-governed CI/CD** at organizations including **National Grid, NESO, Goldman Sachs, and Microsoft**. Increasingly focused on applying **AI/LLM automation to the DevOps toolchain itself** — building retrieval-augmented pipelines that read logs, docs, and change records to accelerate root-cause analysis, automate release notes, and reduce pipeline governance overhead. Comfortable owning delivery automation end-to-end: from pipeline design and IaC through security/governance gates, secrets and connector management, and rollback automation in live production environments.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Continuous Integration (CI)

- Build and test pipeline design across Azure DevOps, Tekton, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity
- Multi-language build orchestration, artifact management (Artifactory), and test-gate enforcement
- Pipeline-as-Code and DSL-based, declarative pipeline definitions

Continuous Delivery (CD) & GitOps

- GitOps-driven continuous delivery with Argo-CD across Kubernetes/OpenShift estates
- Automated, auditable deployments across dev/test/staging/production environment chains
- Multi-cloud delivery orchestration across Azure, AWS, and GCP

Infrastructure-as-Code

- Terraform and Helm for repeatable, version-controlled infrastructure and application delivery

- ARM/Bicep templates, Ansible playbooks for configuration management and drift remediation
- Kustomize for environment-specific manifest overlays

Deployment Strategies

- Rolling, canary, and blue-green deployment patterns for zero/low-downtime releases
- SSL termination, path-based routing, and traffic cutover during live platform migrations
- Progressive delivery patterns tied to observability-driven rollback triggers

Security, Governance & Secrets

- CI/CD security and governance gates (change control, eChips-style approval workflows)
- Secrets management, connector configuration, and RBAC design across pipeline tooling
- WAF policy operation (F5, Zscaler, Checkpoint) and AV/AM scan-before-promote controls
- Automated rollback workflows tied to health checks and deployment gates

AI-Augmented DevOps

- RAG pipelines (n8n → Qdrant → Claude) over logs and documentation for faster root-cause analysis
- LLM-assisted pipeline authoring, IaC validation, and legacy code refactoring
- Anthropic Claude Architect Professional Certification

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

2025 | AI-Augmented CNI Delivery Platform — NESO

Retrieval-augmented pipeline intelligence layered onto a live GitOps delivery platform

- Led SRE/DevOps onboarding for market participants on a multi-cloud CNI platform running OpenShift and Kubernetes across Azure and on-prem data centres, with CI/CD delivered through Azure DevOps Pipelines, Tekton, and Argo-CD.
- Architected a localized RAG framework (n8n → Qdrant → Claude 3.5 Sonnet) over Bitbucket documentation and Loki logs to speed up root-cause analysis, integrated with JIRA and change-management workflows.
- Operated F5/Zscaler/Checkpoint WAF policy and OPSWAT MetaDefender scan-before-promote controls as governance gates ahead of every production promotion.
- **Impact:** faster incident triage and streamlined onboarding of new participants onto governed CI/CD pipelines.

2024 | GitOps & IaC Automation at Scale — National Grid

RHEL/OpenShift transformation with Ansible-driven IaC and Tekton/Argo-CD delivery

- Used Ansible playbooks to automate RHEL server build, patching, and configuration-drift remediation across an OpenShift/VMware estate, replacing manual runbook execution.

- Built Tekton pipelines and Argo-CD GitOps workflows for OpenShift continuous delivery, with Bitbucket version control and Artifactory artefact management.
- Layered a second RAG framework (n8n, Loki, Bitbucket docs, Qdrant, Claude) into the existing Argo-CD/JIRA workflow to automate technical support and root-cause analysis.
- **Impact:** materially cut provisioning time and reduced transformation costs on a CNI programme.

2023 | Enterprise CI/CD Governance — Goldman Sachs

DevSecOps maturity assessment and CI/CD framework rebuild

- Assessed release practices against a DevSecOps Maturity Matrix and built a new CI/CD framework across OpenShift, on-prem gateways, and Azure Sentinel.
- Delivered Azure DevOps-driven CI/CD across GCP, Azure, and AWS, integrating Cloud Build on GCP.
- **Impact:** improved release cadence and reduced manual deployment errors in a regulated financial-services environment.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD Platforms: Azure DevOps (VSTS), Tekton, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Argo-CD, GitOps

Infrastructure-as-Code: Terraform, Helm, Kustomize, Ansible, ARM/Bicep templates, CloudFormation

Deployment Strategies: Rolling, canary, blue-green, progressive delivery, traffic cutover/SSL termination

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, MetalLB, Traefik **Security & Governance:**

Secrets management, connectors, RBAC, WAF policy (F5, Zscaler, Checkpoint), OPSWAT MetaDefender,

change control, rollback automation **Cloud Platforms:** Azure, AWS, GCP **AI/LLM:** Anthropic Claude, RAG

(n8n, Qdrant), LLM-assisted IaC validation and code refactoring, prompt engineering **Observability:**

Grafana, Prometheus (+Thanos), Loki, Jaeger, Kiali, ELK Stack, Application Insights **Scripting/Languages:**

Bash, Python, PowerShell

Certifications: Claude Architect Professional Certification (Anthropic) · Microsoft Certified Architect in

Cloud Solutions (70-532) · MCPS: Developing Microsoft Azure Solutions · Mastering Ansible · Learning

Terraform · Kubernetes with CI/CD Solutions · Kubernetes: Microservices · AWS CloudFormation (IaC) ·

DevOps Foundations: DevSecOps

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

 **Bachelor of Science, Computer Information Technology** Southern New Hampshire University, USA


- Claude Architect Professional Certification (Anthropic)
 - Microsoft Certified Architect in Cloud Solutions
 - Mastering Ansible · Learning Terraform · Kubernetes with CI/CD Solutions
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WHAT HARNESS DOES

Harness is a comprehensive CI/CD and DevOps automation platform that handles:

- **Continuous Integration (CI)** — building and testing pipelines
- **Continuous Delivery (CD) & GitOps** — automated deployments across environments
- **Infrastructure-as-Code management** (Terraform, Helm)
- **Deployment strategies** — rolling, canary, blue-green deployments
- **Security, testing, and governance** for CI/CD pipelines
- **Secrets, connectors, RBAC, and rollback automation**

This maps directly onto twelve years of hands-on delivery: Tekton/Argo-CD GitOps pipelines, Terraform/Helm/Ansible IaC, canary and blue-green cutovers on live CNI and financial-services platforms, F5/Zscaler/OPSWAT governance gates, and secrets/RBAC-governed pipeline design — with the added layer of AI-augmented tooling (RAG over logs and docs, LLM-assisted IaC validation) that Harness's platform is well positioned to absorb natively. The goal: bring that same discipline to Harness's CI/CD and GitOps automation, with a focus on making the AI layer of the platform as production-grade as the deployment engine underneath it.

References and detailed project portfolios available on request.